THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 29, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

"Starship 42 will be the first tower catch"

"As the prophecy foretold, Starship 42 will be the first tower catch," Elon Musk posted at 10:37 p.m. EDT Wednesday. He was quoting SpaceX's post at 12:10 p.m.: "Ship 42 static fires complete. The Starship preparing for Flight 15 performed a full duration, six-engine static fire, and fired a single Raptor engine to simulate a deorbit burn."

Ship 42 was on its way back to the production site after completing its static fire campaign, Tracking The Starbase posted at 11:15 p.m. SpaceX has not announced a date for Flight 15, which Launch Library 2 lists for no earlier than November. The ship would follow the Super Heavy boosters that the tower's arms have already caught at Starbase.

I · SPACEX & STARLINK

"Standard practice"

Starlink kept phones working after Spain's train crash, Putin said he is in close contact with Musk, and the FCC votes on satellite-to-phone spectrum.

482 MHz	~13,000	$145.23
of spectrum for satellite-to-phone service on the FCC's agenda	Starlink satellites launched, according to the company	SPCX close on Wednesday, down 2.25%

"Starlink Mobile is providing free connectivity to @orange_es and @Telefonica customers affected by the devastating train collision in Spain," Starlink posted at 7:37 p.m. EDT Wednesday. "Families, communities, and businesses with compatible LTE phones can stay connected via apps and texts even when cell towers are down." Movistar and Orange switched on the service near the crash site on the Madrid–Seville high-speed line near Urda, in the province of Toledo, ADSLZone reported. "We're supporting communities in Spain with @Starlink Mobile during this difficult time," SpaceX's Stephanie Bednarek posted at 9:37 p.m. Musk replied at 11:06 p.m.: "Standard practice."

Putin: "a real genius"

"He's a genius, a real genius," Russian President Vladimir Putin said of Musk on Wednesday at the Russia-Africa Summit in Moscow, according to a BBC translation. "We are in close contact with our American partners, including Mr. Musk." Putin said the contact matters so that Russia's Rassvet satellites and Starlink do not "interfere with each other in orbit," the BBC reported. A couple of dozen Rassvet satellites are in orbit, against roughly 13,000 Starlinks launched; SpaceX did not respond to the BBC's request for comment.



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

QUICK HIT

"God bless Starlink." A user posted that he was on an international flight "running Grok, replying to feedback on X, and building" with his team, all in parallel. Musk replied at 2:12 a.m. EDT Thursday with a heart.

The FCC votes today

At its open meeting at 10:30 a.m. EDT Thursday, the Federal Communications Commission takes up making an additional

482 megahertz of spectrum available for Supplemental Coverage from Space, the satellite-to-phone service, according to the FCC agenda.

II · TESLA & AUTONOMY

"We even care about the chipmunks"

Musk shared a 98-year-old's FSD story and a Houston union's Robotaxi plug, a Seoul court threw out an FSD refund suit, and the stock slipped.

98	89	−0.80%
age of the Model Y owner whose car stopped for a chipmunk	Korean owners whose FSD refund claims were dismissed	TSLA on Wednesday, to $404.22

"At Tesla, we even care about the chipmunks," Musk wrote at 10:17 a.m. EDT Wednesday, quoting a clip of a 98-year-old man who bought a self-driving Model Y. "I've been driving it probably 2-3 months, and it's not made an error in its driving," the owner says. "In fact, the other day it stopped - a chipmunk was crossing the road."



A Tesla Model Y charges on Odeonsplatz in Munich, Germany, on September 4, 2023.

PHOTO: AUHAIDHAUSEN / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0

"Robotaxi Houston"

At 1:49 p.m. Musk posted "Robotaxi Houston," quoting the Houston Police Officers' Union, which wrote that "With @Tesla expanding their Cybercab/Robotaxi services area across #Houston, there are more ways than ever to get home safely after a night out." The Robotaxi app now offers new riders in Dallas and Houston a free first ride, though not in Austin, and Tesla had not confirmed the offer, TeslaNorth reported.

Seoul court rejects FSD refund suit

The Seoul Central District Court on Thursday dismissed all claims by Tesla owners who bought the Full Self-Driving option between 2019 and 2022 and sued for their money back, ruling that the purchase was not a contractual promise of fully driverless, Level 5 autonomy, the Seoul Economic Daily reported. It said 89 owners had each paid about 9 million won for the option; CNA put the number of plaintiffs at 88. The decision is at the trial-court level.

Tesla slips 0.8%

Tesla shares closed Wednesday at $404.22, down 0.80%, according to Yahoo Finance data. SpaceX's SPCX fell 2.25% to $145.23 (Yahoo Finance).

III · X, GROK & AI

"Just have @Bot buy it somewhere else"

Musk pitched Grok Bot as a bargain hunter, a referral program arrived, and he called rivals' launches and earnings "Impressive."

"Amazon locked out my Grok Bot. So it just bought the same thing from a different site (at a lower price)," James Douma posted at 10:00 p.m. EDT Wednesday. "That's what I do too. Just have @Bot buy it somewhere else at a lower price," Musk replied at 10:30 p.m. When Shopify's Tobi Lütke answered "Just in time for shop pay support," Musk quoted him: "Buy from @Shopify!"

SpaceX has introduced a Grok Bot referral program: an invited friend gets a two-week free trial of Premium, and when that person becomes a paid subscriber the referrer gets a free usage reset, valid for six months, Sawyer Merritt posted at 3:50 p.m. "Try Grok Bot," Musk wrote at 11:09 p.m., quoting a user's post that "grok bot makes work feel like a video game."

"Impressive"

Google chief executive Sundar Pichai introduced Gemini 4 Carbon on Wednesday, two weeks after Argon, saying it "ranks #1 on the recently updated v5.0" of the Artificial Analysis index. Musk replied "Impressive" to Google DeepMind's Demis Hassabis at 1:50 p.m. (post) and quoted Pichai with the same word at 1:59 p.m. (post). To Pichai's post that Alphabet is "now on a half-trillion annual revenue run rate," with Google Cloud revenue up 103%, he replied "Wow." Satya Nadella's note that

Microsoft Cloud revenue "surpassed $63B, with growth accelerating to 30% YoY" drew another "Impressive" (post), and Anthropic's account of drug-discovery partnerships with six organizations drew "Interesting" (post).

QUICK HIT

"Bitstream in, bitstream out." Musk's reply at 10:15 p.m. EDT Wednesday to a post that said "as karpathy said, the ugliest part of the transformer is the tokenizer."

Home offers near xAI's Mississippi plant

Real estate agents for xAI have been offering to buy homes in Southaven, Mississippi, near its power plant, on condition that the owners not join a class-action noise lawsuit against the company, the Guardian reported Wednesday. A realtor told one resident the target is 418 homes, with 18 owners agreed, the paper said; DeSoto County records show five bought since October 9 by MZX, the xAI subsidiary that operates the site. The company denies the lawsuit's claims, and Southaven's mayor said the purchases would house employees and serve as "a goodwill gesture" (Guardian).

"Accelerating exponentially"

"If you look closely enough, breakthroughs in everything are accelerating exponentially. An exponential always starts off looking small," Musk wrote at 11:03 p.m., quoting a list of recent biotech trial results. At 2:04 a.m. Thursday he replied to a joke about a "future of abundance": "Saving money for the distant future is pointless with the advent of super intelligent abundance."

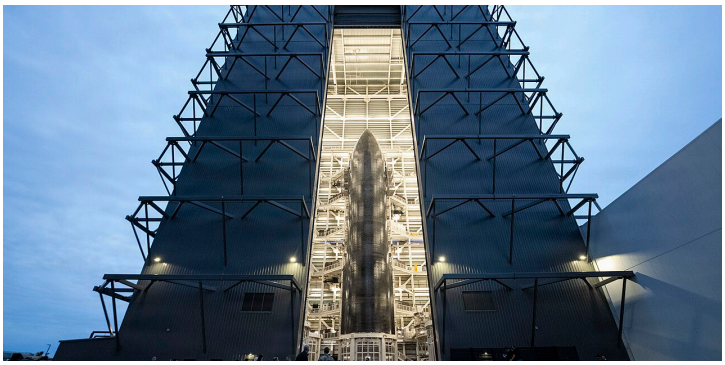
IV · INTERVIEWS & APPEARANCES

Why Starship is steel, and unpainted

A Dwarkesh Podcast clip of Musk on stainless steel drew a follow-up from him on paint.

"Instead of Space Age carbon fiber or aluminum-lithium, SpaceX is building its Starship rocket out of stainless steel," the Dwarkesh Podcast posted at 6:00 p.m. EDT Wednesday with a clip of Musk explaining the choice. "Stainless steel is easy to weld, far cheaper, and under the right conditions, it has a similar strength-to-weight ratio as carbon fiber."

Replying at 2:20 a.m. Thursday, Musk added: "Also, no need to paint stainless. Paint adds more mass & cost."



Ship 39, in bare stainless steel, inside Megabay 2 at Starbase, Texas, on Jan. 12, 2026.

PHOTO: U.S. NAVY PETTY OFFICER 1ST CLASS ALEXANDER KUBITZA / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Takeaways

1. Musk said Ship 42, which finished its static fires for Flight 15, "will be the first tower catch."
2. Starlink Mobile is giving free service to Movistar and Orange customers near Spain's train crash; Musk called it "Standard practice."
3. Putin called Musk "a real genius" and said Russia is in close contact with him on satellites.
4. A Seoul court dismissed Tesla owners' FSD refund claims.
5. Musk urged followers to let Grok Bot find lower prices and to "Buy from @Shopify!"
6. TSLA fell 0.80% to $404.22; SPCX fell 2.25% to $145.23.

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @SpaceX, @TrackingTheSB, @dwarkeshpodcast, @Starlink, @SRBednarek, @EddiePast1, @TheChiefNerd, @HPOUTX, @jamesdouma, @tobi, @SawyerMerritt, @0xgaut, @sundarpichai, @demishassabis, @satyanadella, @AnthropicAI, @willdepue and @m_goes_distance.

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